



VAPCare is an automated system for removing oral secretions from COVID-19 patients on ventilators

to make this device since researchers have recorded an alarmingly high rate of caregiver infections. A high number of nurses and doctors were infected due to exposure to oral and nasal secretions of patients in ICUs on ventilator systems. The VAPCare automates the process of manual suction of secretions which reduces the caregiver's exposure to contagious fluids. The device also allegedly saves nurses up to 90 minutes per patient per day, which comes in handy since the healthcare system is slowly but surely being bogged down by cases of COVID-19. VAPCare is already being used in clinical trials in around 20 Indian hospitals as well as state-owned medical units in Delhi, Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka.

DROOM

Droom, an online automobile marketplace, launched a platform dubbed Droom Health in the wake of the COVID-19 pandemic. The company developed an antimicrobial surface protection shield for cars and two-wheelers and have launched this on the Droom Health platform. Dubbed Corona Shield or Germ Shield, this treatment for automobiles starts at merely ₹499 for bikes and ₹999 for



Droom's Germ Shield or Corona Shield is an antimicrobial surface protection shield for automobiles

cars. This kind of treatment was previously seen to be effective against SARS and other droplet-based viruses. The treatment lasts for a period up to 4 months provided that the automobile doesn't undergo any high-pressure cleaning during this period. Akshay Singh, Vice President, Enterprise and Strategy, Droom, said, "The accumulation of bacteria on frequently-touched surfaces is the key to the transmission of any infection. After the lockdown, when people are ready to step out of their houses, it is important to ensure that there is no virus left alive on their personal vehicles".

The company has stated that the treatment uses the AEGIS Microbe Shield technology. The technology inhibits the growth of microorganisms such as bacteria, algae, yeast, mold and mildew on surfaces. The antimicrobial coating can also rupture the cellular membranes of bacteria and viruses.

GARUDA AEROSPACE

Starting late-March, Chennai-based start-up, Garuda Aerospace began disinfecting hospitals, tall buildings and public spaces to combat the novel coronavirus using its locally-manufactured drones in Tamil Nadu. The startup deployed about 300 drones and 500 drone pilots to disinfect a whopping 50,000 acres in 26 cities. These areas covered public spaces, colleges, educational institutions, private hospitals, and hotels. This innovative plan using pre-existing technology significantly reduces the risk of exposure to the novel coronavirus for sanitation workers. The plan was approved by the Tamil Nadu government on March 23 and the first drone was sent out to disinfect the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital in Chennai. Garuda Aerospace revealed that their drones are specifically designed to fly with heavy loads and can cover a distance of 20 kilometres per day. Each one of their drones carries between 15-20 litres of disinfectants which are provided by the state's health department. Agnishwar Jayaprakash, founder and president of Garuda Aerospace has requested drone own-

ers to volunteer and participate in this project. The team at the startup is now developing designs to modify even smaller drones that can be used for this purpose.



Using drones to disinfect hospitals, public spaces, schools and more

AIISMA

Aiisma, a data marketplace, that rewards its users for consensually trading their behavioural data anonymously via the Aiisma app, has launched a brand new data tracking feature for COVID-19. The app even awards extra compensation for viewing ads on the app. The Aiisma app comes equipped with location sharing and health mapping features which can be used effectively for contact tracing. The company states that the data gathered by Aiisma naturally creates a "digital fence" against the spread of the novel coronavirus and also supports citizens and authorities in their fight against the virus. Aiisma is also working on the release of its health mapping feature, where individuals manually share and monitor health data. Ankit Chaudhari, co-founder, Aiisma believes that data structures make it possible to identify outliers immediately and it then becomes easier to come up with countermeasures to control and react to these outliers. "A common access to this data being created and made available immediately will ensure that the best practices are established and practised across the world in almost real-time", says Chaudhari. Aiisma's app upholds the privacy of the users who are volunteering their data and the information is only revealed to the government or frontline